

ally, a distribution's repository features binaries that have been tested to be compatible with the operating system, and will resolve any dependencies automatically. It also eliminates the need to compile packages from source, which can be intimidating to new users.

We've listed some Linux alternatives to commonly used Windows software, categorised by type. Unless specified otherwise, these applications can be installed from the distribution's default repository or app store, using the built-in package manager. For instance, on a Debian or Debian-based system (such as Ubuntu or Linux Mint), you can install a package using the command:

- `sudo apt-get install <package-name>`

Similarly, on a system that uses RPM-style packages, (such as RedHat, Fedora or OpenSUSE) the Yum Package Manager can be used to install a package:

- `sudo yum install <package-name>`

The `sudo` command ensures that the user has the required permissions to install/update software on the machine.

In cases where the particular application is NOT available in the distribution's repositories, we've included links to the developer's website where the application binaries are hosted.

I. Music and Video

We all use our computers for entertainment, so a suite of applications that organise and play your music and video collection is essential. Linux boasts of a rich suite of applications for every perceivable need of yours – be it an iTunes type regular music library organiser, a lightweight music player for when you don't want to load up your entire music collection, a video player that will play any possible format you throw at it or even applications that let you edit and produce music.

1. Banshee/Rhythmbox

If you're facing iTunes withdrawal symptoms after switching over to Linux, both Banshee and Rhythmbox will fill that void pretty well. Most distros ship at least one of these two applications for media management, and not